



INTERNAL SECURITY

MODULE - 15

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

STATE WISE STATUS OF INSURGENCY

ASSAM – CREATION OF BODO LAND



1

A tripartite agreement was signed between the Centre, Assam Government and the Bodo representatives, including all factions of National Democratic Front of Bodoland and the All Bodo Students Union.

2

It aims at ending the 34-year long Bodo movement in Assam that killed 4,000 people and resulted in several rounds of ethnic tensions.



BHUTAN

KOKRAJHAR

CHIRANG

UDALGURI

ARUNACHAL PRADESH

WEST BENGAL

BAKSA

NAGALAND

MEGHALAYA

MANIPUR

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

BANGLADESH



BODOLAND TERRITORIAL
AUTONOMOUS DISTRICTS

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

ASSAM – CREATION OF BODO LAND

- 3** **Focused development of Bodo villages outside BTAD** — which opens up a way to potentially address the needs of Bodos outside BTAD.



- 2** A commission appointed by the State Government will examine and recommend, if villages **contiguous** to BTAD and with a **majority tribal population can be included** into the BTR, while those now in BTAD and with a majority non-tribal population can opt out of the BTR.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE THIRD BODO ACCORD

- 1** The area under the jurisdiction of **BTC** is now renamed **Bodoland Territorial Region (BTR)**.

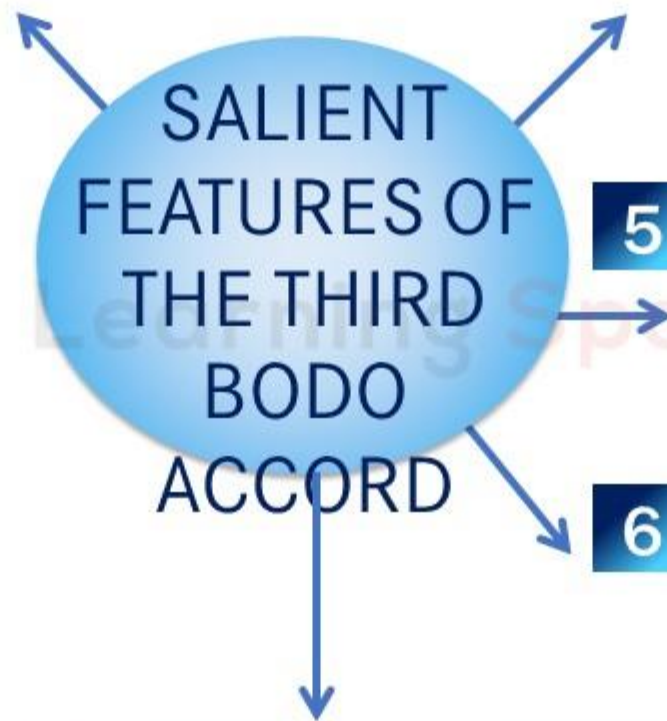


At present, BTAD accounts for 11% of Assam's area and 10% of its population. As per available reports, only 27% of the BTAD population is Bodo.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

ASSAM – CREATION OF BODO LAND

- 8 The agreement says, negotiations were held with Bodo organisations for a comprehensive and final solution to their demands while keeping **intact the territorial integrity** of the State of Assam.



- 4 Bodo language with Devanagiri script will be notified as an **associate official language**.

- 5 1,500 NDFB men **surrender arms** on January 30 and disband their outfits.

- 6 A **Special Development Package** of Rs. 1500 crores over three years is provided.

- 7 Bodos living in hills would be conferred **Scheduled Hill Tribe status**.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

CRITICAL APPRAISAL OF THIRD BODO ACCORD

POSITIVES

- It would lead to the end of one of long running insurgencies in the Northeast.
- Northeast can truly enjoy fruits of peace and development and become a bridge between India and Southeast Asia under Act East Policy.
- This can become a solution to other insurgency movements.



AREAS OF CONCERN

- Land being at the core of the Bodo movement, not bringing on board the non-Bodo population could see a repeat of ethnic tensions down the line.
- It is pertinent to note majority in the designated Bodo areas are non-Bodos.



NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

ASSAM – CREATION OF BODO LAND

CAUSES OF RECURRING VIOLENCE IN THIS AREA

5

Inclusion of **illegal migrants** in the **voters list** is viewed as a deliberate ploy to empower an outside group vis-à-vis the Bodos, so that the latter lose their distinct indigenous identity. This has created a siege mentality among Bodos.

4

Fear **psychosis** in the Bodo community that their ancestral lands will be illegally taken away by the migrants.



1

Fear of non-Bodo community dominating the political process

2

Political tension compounded by **migration of illegal Bangladeshis**, relegating them to a minority status in their own land.

3

Another cause is the **existence of armed groups** like the NDFB-S, the Birsa Commando Force (BCF) representing the Santhals, etc., which have the capability to challenge the authority of the state administration.

CAUSES



NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

5 Here, the main activities involves mobilization of the masses, political awakening, visiting villages, engaging in small struggles on local issues, picking up students' issues, fighting corruption, short-listing shelter and arms dumps and identification of local militant elements.

4 The Maoist rebellion in Northeast India is at present in a very incipient stage.

MAOIST CONSOLIDATION IN NORTH EAST

1 The Maoists have been able to extend their activities to the Northeast.

2 The arrests of various top Maoist leaders in this region during 2013 revealed the extent of Maoist infiltration in Northeast India.

3 Though at present they are restricted to certain pockets of this region, like along the Assam-Arunachal Pradesh border areas, there is every possibility that they can extend their influence.



NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

3

With low levels of development and lack of access to proper education and healthcare services in various parts of the region, especially in the Muslim-dominated char or riverine areas of Assam, fundamentalists may try to lure people towards their fold using these issues.

1

Northeast India, shares an 1880 km long porous border with Bangladesh, a country that is a hotbed of Islamist militancy.

2

Though Islamist militancy is yet to find a root in Northeast, we may see efforts from Islamists to spread radical Islam among the Muslim population in the region.

SPREAD OF ISLAMIST MILITANCY



NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

FACTORS RESPONSIBLE FOR INSURGENCY IN THE NORTHEAST



1. Lack of development and basic amenities coupled with corruption
2. Unemployment problem in the region stands as a major cause for sustained insurgency
3. Feeling of alienation and deprivation among the tribal population
4. Demographic problems associated with political boundaries.
5. Similar ethnicity across the border on Myanmar side
6. Porosity of the border with Myanmar due to difficult terrain
7. Change in demographic pattern due to infiltration from across the border

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

FACTORS RESPONSIBLE FOR INSURGENCY IN THE NORTHEAST



8. Disconnect with the other parts of India and fellow Indians.
9. Widespread corruption among the ruling elite
10. Lack of visionary leadership among the tribal communities
11. Easy availability of arms and ammunition
12. Political support from various factions
13. Instability in Myanmar
14. Factional in-fighting among the insurgent groups
15. Military reasons – AFSPA (Armed Forces Special Power Act).
16. External support – China and Myanmar

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

CHALLENGES AND CONCERNS

1. THE LINKAGE WITH ORGANISED CRIME

- The biggest challenge to the North East is extortion carried out by various insurgent groups.
- Extortion has become meticulously organised activity in the region and is one of the major sources of funds for the militants.
- Other sources of their funding include arms and drugs smuggling.



2. MAOIST CONSOLIDATION IN NORTH-EAST

- The Maoists have been able to extend the red corridor to the Northeast.
- The arrests of various top Maoist leaders in this region during 2013 revealed the extent of Maoist infiltration in Northeast India.
- The Maoist rebellion in Northeast India involves mobilization of the masses, political awakening, visiting villages, engaging in small struggles on local issues, picking up students' issues, fighting corruption, short-listing shelter and arms dumps and identification of local militant elements.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

CHALLENGES AND CONCERNS

3. SPREAD OF ISLAMIST MILITANCY

- Northeast India, shares an 1880 km long porous border with Bangladesh, a country that is a hotbed of Islamist militancy.
- Though radical Islam has not yet seeped into the Muslim population in the region, the arrests of 12 persons in Assam during November-December 2014 with links with the Islamist terror outfit Jamaat-ul-Mujahideen Bangladesh (JMB) shows that radicalization of a section of Muslim population has begun in the region.

4. TRANSNATIONAL LINKAGES

- India's Northeast is one of South Asia's hottest spots, not simply because the region has as many as 30 armed insurgent organisation operating and fighting the Indian State, but because trans-border linkages that these groups have, and strategic alliances among them, have acted as force multipliers and have made the conflict dynamics all the more intricate.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

THE IMPACT OF INSURGENCY OF ECONOMY

The persistent insurgency atmosphere has been the most important contributor to economic stagnation of the region.



1. CONNECTIVITY

- The gateway to the North Eastern Region is the chicken's neck of Siliguri area in North Bengal and all flows to and from the Region on the surface routes have to pass through this neck and the Brahmaputra Valley of Assam, Guwahati being the grand nodal point.
- Therefore, any disturbance in the Brahmaputra Valley and/or its adjoining hills brings the activities in the whole of the Region to a stand-still position.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

THE IMPACT OF INSURGENCY OF ECONOMY



2. INFRASTRUCTURE

- The subversive activities of the insurgents' damage rail tracks, cause accidents leading to loss of life and property, create terror among the travellers and throw the entire system out of gear.
- Similarly, vehicles in the State and National highways are often attacked, passengers and transport workers are killed or wounded and sometimes abducted for ransom; and goods are looted.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

THE IMPACT OF INSURGENCY OF ECONOMY

3. INDUSTRY INCLUDING PETROLEUM AND TEA

As the articulated economic grievance hovers around the idea of so called regional colonialism based on the alleged drain of rich resources of the region, any violent political movement makes petroleum and tea as its target.



4. ENVIRONMENT

- On the one hand, insurgents damage forests by taking shelter there and on the other, anti insurgency operations also lead to denudation of forests.
- This not only means that conservation activities and other forestry operations are hampered thus resulting in the loss of valuable natural resources but also that a grave threat is posed to the fragile ecology of the region.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

THE IMPACT OF INSURGENCY OF ECONOMY



5. DEVELOPMENT OF THE INTERIOR AREAS

- The insurgency has aggravated the problem to such an extent that development workers of both the Government and NGOs are utterly discouraged from going to the hilly and rural areas as they face constant extortion and threats of abduction or death.
- The insurgents by breeding a cult of hatred against the supposed or real outsiders are blocking all inflows of resources, ideas, expertise and initiative to be societies of the North East.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

RECENT INITIATIVES BY THE GOVERNMENT FOR DEVELOPMENT OF THE NORTH-EAST

1. FROM LOOK EAST POLICY (LEP) TO ACT EAST POLICY

A greater focus on:

- External Angle: Essentially, concerning relations of India as a whole with ASEAN & East Asia
- Internal Angle : Development of North East India that makes it a viable gate way for the rest of India to ASEAN & East Asia



2. THE KALADAN MULTI MODAL TRANSIT PROJECT

The project will connect Sittwe port in Myanmar to the India-Myanmar border. It will provide alternative cost effective shortcut to landlocked north eastern states.



THE KALADAN MULTIMODAL TRANSIT PROJECT



NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

RECENT INITIATIVES BY THE GOVERNMENT FOR DEVELOPMENT OF THE NORTH-EAST



3. THE INDIA-MYANMAR- THAILAND TRILATERAL

- Also, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) is planning to extend the proposed India-Myanmar-Thailand highway to the Cambodia, Lao PDR and Vietnam countries in the second phase.
- This will then give India direct access to the South-East and East Asian markets.

THE INDIA-MYANMAR- THAILAND TRILATERAL HIGHWAY



NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

RECENT INITIATIVES BY THE GOVERNMENT FOR DEVELOPMENT OF THE NORTH-EAST

4. DEVELOPMENT OF MOREH AS A SMART CITY

- Manipur is the most critical state in India's connectivity to Myanmar and South East Asia.
- 99% of overland formal trade goes through Moreh.



5. NORTH EAST IN HYDROCARBON VISION

Aims to double oil and gas output



NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

RECENT INITIATIVES BY THE GOVERNMENT FOR DEVELOPMENT OF THE NORTH-EAST

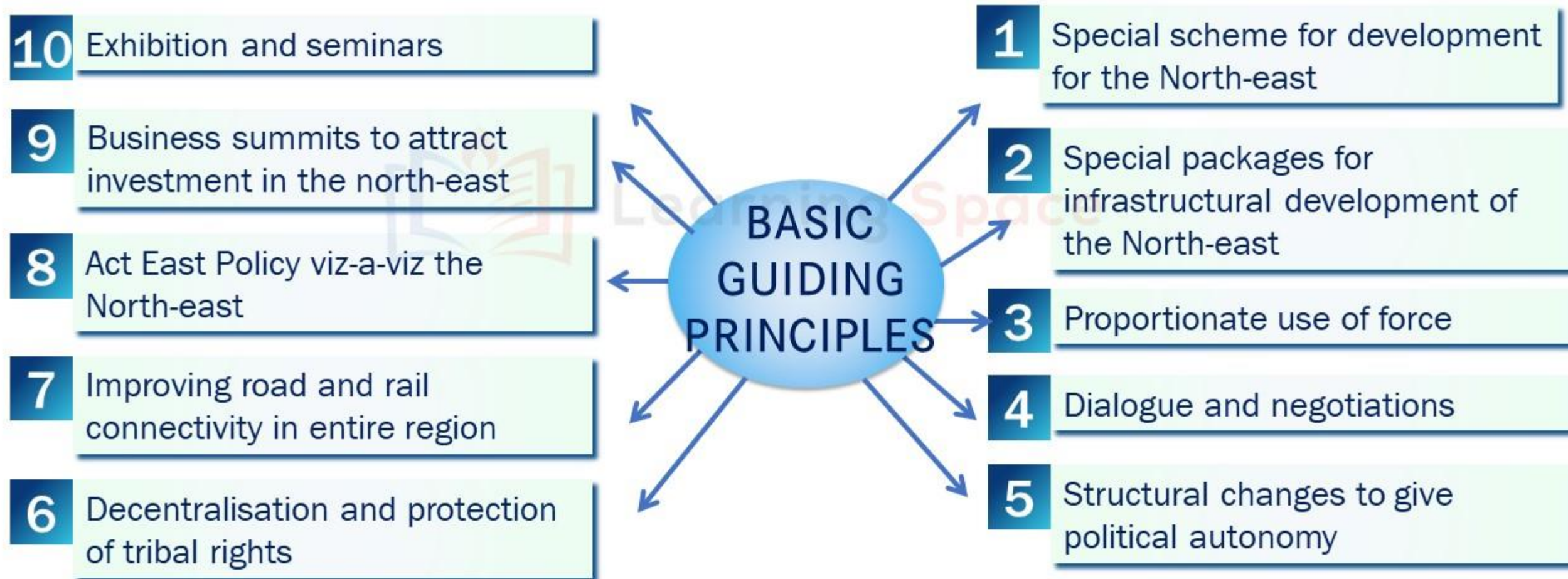


6. NORTH EAST RURAL LIVELIHOOD PROJECT

- NERLP is World Bank aided, multi-state livelihood Rs.683 crore project under the Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (DoNER), launched in 2012.
- The project has been implemented in 11 districts of Mizoram, Nagaland, Tripura and Sikkim.
- The project aims “to improve rural livelihoods especially that of women, unemployed youth and the most disadvantaged, in four North Eastern States”.
- The objective is to create sustainable community institutions around women Self Help Groups (SHG), Community development groups (CDG) and the youth of the select districts.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

GUIDING PRINCIPLES OF GOVERNMENT TO TACKLE NORTHEAST EXTREMISM



NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

INSURGENCY AND THEIR FOREIGN LINKS



- 1 The biggest foreign link of North-east insurgents are believed to be with Myanmar.

- 2 India has a long international border shared by four states, Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram, with Myanmar.

- 3 Difficult terrain and ethnic linkages of population on both sides of the border make it easy for the Indian insurgent groups/underground groups (IGs/UGs) in the movement across the border as well as establishing camps, including training of fresh recruits, weapon procurement and their transfer to India.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

INSURGENCY AND THEIR FOREIGN LINKS

- 4** Apart from Myanmar, Bangladesh has been used by North-east insurgent groups as a hide-out, especially in the Chittagong hills. However, after the takeover of the Sheikh Hasina Government, it is on the decline and many members of such groups have been arrested and handed over to India.
- 5** Nepal is being used as a hideout and transit to other countries adjoining China. Kathmandu airport is the transit point.
- 6** Bhutan is also used by many of the Assam based underground groups like ULFA and NDFB. There are inputs which suggest moral support of the Chinese to the north-east insurgent groups.
- 7** Among these, the Chinese support to insurgents in the northeast came early in the 1960s and continued through the 1970s.
- 8** With the Chinese support the Naga insurgency became stronger and more intense with better tactics and modern weapons.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

WAY FORWARD



- 1** The key issue with regard to the residents to the north-east is the feeling of the alienation and lack of development.
- 2** They feel that their culture is not promoted in the right perspective in the rest of the country.
- 3** They also feel that because of their distinct facial features they are compared more to the Chinese. These are the reasons for insurgency plaguing the north-east.

NORTH-EAST INSURGENCY

Dialogue involving all the stakeholders and not a single group.

- Humanising AFSPA
- Rebel groups to be brought within constitutional mandate

- Economic development
- Improved governance

- Political autonomy
- Sixth schedule

STEPS TO BE TAKEN FOR AVERTING INSURGENCY

Cooperative federalism

Intelligence sharing between state and central forces



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